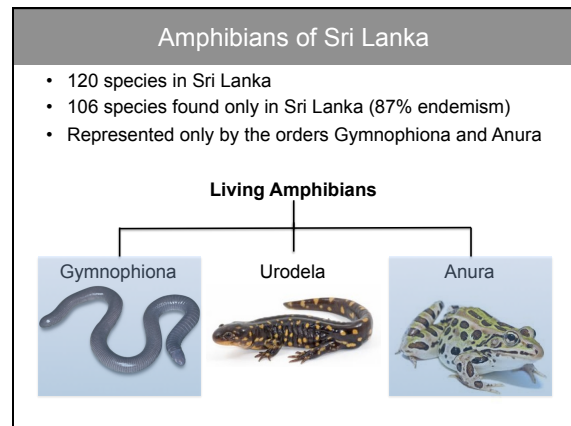




Amphibians of Sri Lanka

- Represented by 7 families
- No families endemic to Sri Lanka

Order	Families
Gymnophiona	Ichthyophiidae
Anura	Bufonidae Dicroglossidae Microhylidae Ranidae Nyctibatrachidae Rhacophoridae

Amphibians of Sri Lanka

Order: Gymnophiona, Family Ichthyophiidae

- Commonly called caecilians
- Limbless amphibians
- Fossorial and live in moist soils close to water
- Have blunt heads and cylindrical limbless bodies with short tails
- One genus in Sri Lanka: *Ichthyophis*
- Three species in Sri Lanka, all endemic
 - *Ichthyophis glutinosus*
 - *Ichthyophis pseudangularis*
 - *Ichthyophis orthoplicatus*



Amphibians of Sri Lanka

Order: Anura

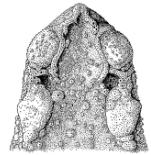
- Commonly called frogs and toads
- Short stout bodies, tailless
- Six families of Anurans are found in Sri Lanka
 - Bufonidae
 - Dicroglossidae
 - Microhylidae
 - Ranidae
 - Nyctibatrachidae
 - Rhacophoridae



Amphibians of Sri Lanka

Order: Anura, Family: Bufonidae

- Commonly known as toads
- Have thick, warty and a glandular skin
- Concentration of glands in the temporal-neck area forming the prominent parotid gland
- Pupil of the eye is horizontal
- Reproduce by depositing strands of eggs in water
- In Sri Lanka 7 species are present in two genera: *Adenomus* and *Duttaphrynus*
- Five are endemic to Sri Lanka



Amphibians of Sri Lanka

Order: Anura, Family: Bufonidae

- Genus *Adenomus* is endemic to Sri Lanka: Two species

*Adenomus kelaartii**Adenomus kandianus*

Amphibians of Sri Lanka

Order: Anura, Family: Bufonidae*Duttaphrynus melanostictus*

Amphibians of Sri Lanka

Order: Anura, Family: Bufonidae*Duttaphrynus noellerti**Duttaphrynus kotagamai**Duttaphrynus scaber*

Amphibians of Sri Lanka

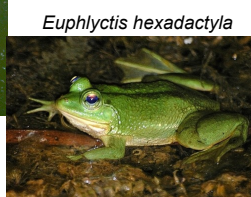
Order: Anura, Family: Dicroglossidae

- Posses a forked tongue
- Has a moist glandular skin
- Most have highly webbed feet
- Has a free living aquatic larval stage
- Thirteen (13) species in five genera are found in Sri Lanka
 - Euphlyctis*
 - Hoplobatrachus*
 - Nannophrys*
 - Sphaerotheca*
 - Zakerana*
- Six species endemic to Sri Lanka
- Genus *Nannophrys* is endemic to Sri Lanka

Amphibians of Sri Lanka

Order: Anura, Family: Dicroglossidae

- Two species in the genus *Euphlyctis*
- Fully aquatic species

*Euphlyctis cyanophlyctis**Euphlyctis hexadactyla*

Amphibians of Sri Lanka

Order: Anura, Family: Dicroglossidae

- Two species in the genus *Hoplobatrachus*
- Fully aquatic species
- *Hoplobatrachus tigerinus* considered to be locally extinct

*Hoplobatrachus crassus*

Amphibians of Sri Lanka

Order: Anura, Family: Dicroglossidae

- Four species in the genus *Nannophrys* (Rock frogs)
- Genus endemic to Sri Lanka
- *Nannophrys guentheri* is considered to be extinct

*Nannophrys marmorata*Semi-terrestrial tadpoles of
Nannophrys ceylonensis

Amphibians of Sri Lanka

Order: Anura, Family: Dicroglossidae

- Three species in the genus *Sphaerotheca*
- Burrowing species

*Sphaerotheca breviceps**Sphaerotheca rolandae*

Amphibians of Sri Lanka

Order: Anura, Family: Dicroglossidae

- Three species in the genus *Minervarya*
- Aquatic and semi-terrestrial
- Two species endemic to Sri Lanka

*Minervarya syhadrensis**Minervarya kirtisinghei*

Amphibians of Sri Lanka

Order: Anura, Family: Microhylidae

- Have stout hind legs, short snouts
- Commonly called 'Narrow-mouthed frogs'
- Globose bodies with a teardrop shape
- Keratinous teeth absent in larvae
- Pupils are horizontal or round
- Ten species known from Sri Lanka, five (05) are endemic to Sri Lanka
- Two genera – *Microhyla*
Uperodon



Amphibians of Sri Lanka

Order: Anura, Family: Microhylidae

- Four species in the genus *Microhyla*
- Two species endemic to Sri Lanka
- Terrestrial species

*Microhyla mihintalei**Microhyla zeylanica*

Amphibians of Sri Lanka

Order: Anura, Family: Microhylidae

Genus *Uperodon*: 6 species in Sri Lanka, 3 endemic species

Uperodon taprobanicus

*Uperodon systema*

Amphibians of Sri Lanka

Order: Anura, Family: Microhylidae

*Uperodon rohani**Uperodon obscurus*

Amphibians of Sri Lanka

Order: Anura, Family: Nyctibatrachidae

- Single genus (*Lankanectes*) in Sri Lanka
- *Lankanectes* is a genus endemic to Sri Lanka
- Consists of two species
- Adults bear two large teeth on the lower jaw
- Dorsum with numerous transverse folds on the skin
- Adults and tadpoles are completely aquatic
- Adults retain the lateral line
- Found in the wet and intermediate zones of Sri Lanka

Amphibians of Sri Lanka

Order: Anura, Family: Nyctibatrachidae

Lankanectes corrugata



Amphibians of Sri Lanka

Order: Anura, Family: Ranidae

- Smooth moist skin with powerful legs and webbed feet
- Characterized by a dorso-lateral ridge that runs along the body from snout to vent
- Also possesses round digital disks
- Three species are recorded from Sri Lanka
- Belonging to two genera *Hydrophylax* and *Indosylvirana*
- All three are endemic to Sri Lanka
- All three species are closely associated with water

Amphibians of Sri Lanka

Order: Anura, Family: Ranidae

*Hyldrophylax gracilis**Indosylvirana temporalis*

Amphibians of Sri Lanka

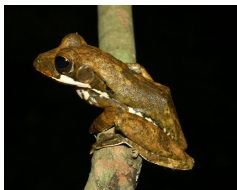
Order: Anura, Family: Rhacophoridae

- Arboreal frogs
- Commonly called tree-frogs or bush-frogs
- Has enlarged toepads and relatively long limbs
- Have flattened bodies
- Large eyes with horizontal pupils
- Largest family of amphibians in Sri Lanka
- 82 species and 81 endemic species
- Three genera of Rhacophorids are present in Sri Lanka
 - *Polypedates*
 - *Pseudophilautus*
 - *Taruga*: genus endemic to Sri Lanka

Amphibians of Sri Lanka

Order: Anura, Family: Rhacophoridae

- Three species of *Polypedates* in Sri Lanka
- Two are endemic to Sri Lanka: *P. cruciger*, *P. ranwellai*

*Polypedates cruciger**Polypedates ranwellai*

Amphibians of Sri Lanka

Order: Anura, Family: Rhacophoridae

*Polypedates maculatus*Tadpole of *Polypedates cruciger*Foam nest of *Polypedates maculatus*

Amphibians of Sri Lanka

Order: Anura, Family: Rhacophoridae

- Species of *Pseudophilautus* are small to medium (20-50mm SVL) sized frogs
- Arboreal or semi-terrestrial
- Commonly known as 'Shrub frogs'
- The most diverse genus of frogs in Sri Lanka with 76 species
- All are endemic to Sri Lanka
- 16 species are thought to be already extinct from the island
- Majority are confined to the wet zone forests of Sri Lanka

Amphibians of Sri Lanka

Order: Anura, Family: Rhacophoridae: *Pseudophilautus* spp.

Amphibians of Sri Lanka

Order: Anura, Family: Rhacophoridae

- Reproduction - direct development, larval development that occurs within the eggs so that hatchlings resemble miniature adults



Amphibians of Sri Lanka

Order: Anura, Family: Rhacophoridae

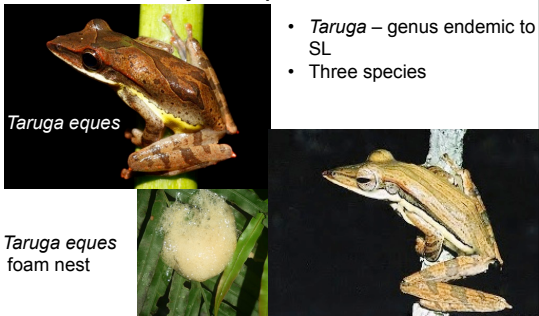
- Some shrub frogs lay direct developing eggs on leaves (e.g. *Pseudophilautus femoralis*)



Amphibians of Sri Lanka

Order: Anura, Family: Rhacophoridae

- Taruga* – genus endemic to SL
- Three species



Taruga eques

Taruga eques
foam nest

Taruga longinasus